

Employee Capability Checklist – Cory Shepherd

*** Please note that a separate medical certificate is also required to support the completed Capability Checklist.*

Information provided in the Capability Checklist below will assist our Organisation to determine appropriate tasks in the event that the identified worker is cleared for suitable duties. Please ensure that all sections of the Capability Checklist are completed in full.

I have examined Cory Lea Shepherd (DOB 11 January 1991) and consider that they are diagnosed with the following condition:

Major Depressive Disorder with anxious distress (DSM-5 296.23) — work-related psychological injury, onset 18 June 2024.

☒ I have viewed the worker's Position Description (attached — Administration Officer, Switchboard Services (AO3), Logan Hospital) and/or

☒ I am aware of the requirements of their role

It is my opinion that they are fit to resume:

☐ Normal duties

☒ Modified duties

☒ Reduced hours (hours/days)

☐ Workplace Performance Discussions

Modified duties relate to:

☒ Tasks performed

☒ Duration

Hours to be worked

Week 1: 8 hours/day 3 days/week	Week 5: 8 hours/day 3 days/week
Week 2: 8 hours/day 3 days/week	Week 6: 8 hours/day 3 days/week
Week 3: 8 hours/day 3 days/week	Week 7: 8 hours/day 3 days/week
Week 4: 8 hours/day 3 days/week	Week 8: 8 hours/day 3 days/week
(6 shifts per 10-shift fortnight: max 2 weekday day/afternoon + 2 night + 2 weekend shifts — continuation of the reduced pattern Mr Shepherd has sustained since 2025)	

Fit to commence the above from: 3 July 2026 (continuation of existing arrangement)

Date of next review: 28 August 2026 (approximately 8 weeks)

Nature of duties

Activity	No capacity	Restricted / As Tolerated	Normal	Details of any restrictions and reasons
COGNITIVE				
Learning new tasks	☐	☐	☒	
Ability to initiate tasks independently	☐	☐	☒	
Understanding instructions	☐	☐	☒	
Carrying out instructions accurately	☐	☐	☒	
Maintain focus/concentration	☐	☒	☐	Concentration reduced during sustained high-stress periods; managed by rostering to lower call-volume shifts.
Executing tasks within a reasonable timeframe	☐	☐	☒	
Working autonomously without supervision	☐	☐	☒	
Prioritising tasks	☐	☐	☒	
Making decisions	☐	☐	☒	
Multi-tasking	☐	☒	☐	Concurrent high-volume demand exacerbates symptoms; suitable on lower-volume shifts.
Memorising information	☐	☒	☐	Working memory affected under stress (treating psychiatrist report 13-Feb-2025).
Working in a high demand environment	☐	☒	☐	Limit weekday day/afternoon shifts — which carry the peak call volume and the majority of complaints — to no more than 2 per fortnight; remaining shifts rostered to the lower-volume weekend (2) and night (2) shifts.
RELATIONAL				
Communicating with internal/external customers	☐	☐	☒	
Working in a team environment	☐	☐	☒	
Handling conflict	☐	☒	☐	No complaint-handling duties: complaints received at the Switchboard are to be logged and redirected to management/the dedicated complaints area, not actioned, resolved or absorbed by Mr Shepherd.
Supervising others	☐	☐	☒	Not a requirement of the AO3 role.
Interacting appropriately with others	☐	☐	☒	
Do you foresee any existing stressors that could impact on a return to substantive role? If so, please provide additional comments:				Yes. (1) Complaint-handling exposure at the Switchboard; (2) being held accountable, and blamed, for failures that are the responsibility of others across the hospital, regardless of where the fault lies; (3) rostering and fatigue-management practices; (4) unresolved workplace matters involving line management. Recommend return-to-work communications and this checklist be managed through the Injury Management team, Human Resources.

Medications

Is the worker currently taking any medication?

☒ Yes

☐ No

Please outline any side effects from medication currently being taken that may impact on a person's functional capacity or task performance (for example drowsiness, dizziness, confusion, impaired concentration, fatigue, slurred speech):

Current medications:

1. Fluoxetine 60 mg mane (3 × 20 mg capsules).
2. Lisdexamfetamine (Vyvanse) 30 mg mane — for cognitive symptoms and focus.

Quetiapine (Seroquel) 25 mg nocte, previously prescribed for rumination and sleep, has been ceased.

Relevant effects on task performance: maintaining a regular sleep routine remains central to symptom management following cessation of the night-time medication. This supports (a) limiting night shifts to no more than 2 per fortnight, (b) predictable rostering published in advance, and (c) a minimum 10-hour break between rostered shifts consistent with the applicable Award and fatigue risk management standards. Residual symptoms include reduced concentration and working memory under sustained high-demand load and fatigue sensitivity.

Additional Comments:

1. Please elaborate on the current medical condition Mr Shepherd is suffering from?

Major Depressive Disorder with anxious distress (DSM-5 296.23), a work-related psychological injury with onset 18 June 2024. Treatment is ongoing (fluoxetine, lisdexamfetamine) under psychiatric care. Residual symptoms most relevant to work capacity are reduced concentration and working memory under sustained high-demand load, fatigue sensitivity, and symptom exacerbation on exposure to the identified workplace stressors (complaint handling; being held accountable and blamed for the failures of others; unpredictable rostering).

2. In your opinion do you feel that Mr Shepherd's current condition is temporary, episodic or permanent in nature? What is the expected duration of the current restrictions?

Episodic, with symptom exacerbation linked to stressor exposure. The restrictions below are expected to remain necessary for at least the next 3–6 months, subject to treatment response and 8-weekly review.

3. Based on your current assessment, what work capacity (including number of shifts, hours, and type of duties) would best support Mr Shepherd's recovery while minimising risk of exacerbation?

Six 8-hour shifts per fortnight (of the ten rostered in a full-time fortnight), comprising:

(a) No more than two weekday day/afternoon shifts. These shifts carry the peak call volume and the majority of complaints — the identified stressors. Retaining two per fortnight maintains graded exposure to the full role and preserves work capacity; the cap prevents multiple high-load shifts accumulating within a fortnight, which is the pattern associated with symptom exacerbation.

(b) Two weekend day shifts. Weekend call volume and complaint exposure are materially lower while the duties are identical, allowing the same work to be performed at an intensity consistent with Mr Shepherd's current concentration and working-memory capacity, and preserving a normal sleep-wake cycle.

(c) No more than two night shifts at this stage. Night shifts are low in volume and complaints, but a stable sleep routine is central to symptom management following cessation of the night-time medication; capping nights protects that routine and limits cumulative fatigue. This cap is suitable for reassessment at review.

This reduced pattern of approximately six shifts per fortnight is the pattern Mr Shepherd has in fact worked and tolerated over the past twelve months without deterioration, and maintaining rather than increasing it best supports recovery while minimising risk of exacerbation. Usual switchboard operational duties remain suitable; complaint-handling duties are excluded as below.

4. Are there any specific workplace modifications or supports you would recommend (e.g. reduced workload, predictable rostering, supervision level, reduced exposure to stressors) to assist Mr Shepherd during this period?

(a) No complaint-handling duties — complaints received at the Switchboard to be logged and redirected, not actioned or resolved by Mr Shepherd; (b) predictable rostering published in advance, with a minimum 10-hour break between shifts consistent with the Award and fatigue risk management standards; (c) return-to-work coordination and correspondence through the Injury Management team, Human Resources; (d) access to EAP (TELUS Health) as an available support; (e) review in approximately 8 weeks.

Please complete this form and return to the Injury Management team, Logan & Beaudesert Health Service, Human Resources by email lbh_injurymangement@health.qld.gov.au

Please include your practice details/stamp here

Signature

Date



3-7-26.

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Dr Day Hong Ma

MBBS, FRACGP, FACRRM Provider No: 4696842K

16/3221 Surfers Paradise Blvd

Surfers Paradise, QLD 4217

Ph: 07-5592 2299 Fax: 07-5539 9188

www.mydoctorsclinicsurfers.com.au